WEMA BANK HACKAHOLICS 7.0 · POWERING POSSIBILITIES

Concept Note

VENDORA

The voice-first business assistant for Nigerian traders, built on Wema Bank and ALAT

Item	Details
Focus area	Financial Inclusion (with Digital Transformation)
Team	Team Vendora · women-led team
Banking partner	Wema Bank / ALAT
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Status	Confidential, for Hackaholics 7.0 submission only

1. Executive summary

Nigeria's market traders move billions of naira every day, but most of them keep no reliable records. Sales are written in paper notebooks, stock is counted in the head, and fake transfer alerts cost traders money. Without records, banks cannot see these businesses, so traders stay locked out of loans.

Vendora is a voice-first business assistant that lets traders run their business by talking, in English, Pidgin, Yoruba, Igbo or Hausa. A trader says "I sold two bags of rice to Mama Chidi," and Vendora updates stock, sales, profit and customer debts automatically.

Vendora is built on Wema Bank. Every trader banks with **ALAT by Wema**, every payment is confirmed directly by the bank, and the trader's daily records become a **Vendora Business Score**. With the trader's permission, Wema uses this score to offer **restock loans paid straight to suppliers**, repaid in small daily amounts from sales.

> **In one line:** traders get an assistant that works in their language and protects their money. Wema gets new accounts, more deposits and payments, and safe small-business borrowers it can see clearly.

2. The problem

In markets like Mile 12 (Lagos), Ariaria (Aba), Bodija (Ibadan) and Singa (Kano), traders handle hundreds of sales a day under pressure. Five problems hold them back:

1. **No time to write records.** Writing every sale during busy hours is impossible, so records are made at night from memory, and many sales are lost.
2. **Paper records get destroyed.** Rain, fire and loss can wipe out a whole business history, including money customers owe.
3. **Fake transfer alerts.** Scammers show fake SMS alerts. Checking a banking app during a busy sale is slow, so traders let customers go without confirming payment.
4. **Apps that don't fit.** Existing bookkeeping apps need typing, English and menus. Many traders are more comfortable speaking Pidgin or their local language.
5. **No records, no loans.** Banks can't lend to a business they can't see, so traders depend on expensive informal credit, or don't restock at all.

Shop owners with apprentices face a sixth problem: **money and stock go missing**, and the owner cannot tell who sold what.

3. The solution: Vendora

Vendora's promise is simple: **"The trader doesn't manage data. Vendora does."** The trader talks; Vendora listens, understands and records.

How a sale works

Step	What happens
1. Trader speaks	"Mo ta bags meji ti rice" (I sold two bags of rice), in any supported language, even mixed.

Step	What happens
2. Vendora understands	It detects the language, then pulls out the item, quantity, price and customer.
3. Records update	Stock goes down, the sale and profit are recorded, and any customer debt is noted.
4. Payment confirmed	If the customer pays by transfer, Wema confirms the money arrived and matches it to the sale.
5. Vendora replies	It confirms out loud in the trader's language: "Recorded. Rice: 2 bags left."

One assistant, two ways in

- **The Vendora app** is the home base: stock, sales, charts, insights, the Business Score and loan offers.
- **Vendora on WhatsApp** is the quick door: traders send a voice note and the sale appears in the app instantly. They open the app whenever they want to see more.
- **Works offline:** sales, stock, debts and daily totals are saved on the phone first and sync automatically when network returns.

4. Key features

Core features (free for every trader)

Feature	What it does
Voice recording in 5 languages	Record sales, restocks and debts by speaking English, Pidgin, Yoruba, Igbo or Hausa, including mixed languages.
Automatic stock tracking	Every sale updates stock. Low-stock and out-of-stock warnings arrive before the trader runs out.
Wema payment confirmation	Payments to the trader's ALAT account are confirmed by the bank itself, so fake alerts no longer work.
Pay-per-sale account numbers	Vendora can create a one-time Wema account number or QR code for the exact amount of a sale. Payment is matched to that sale automatically.
Customer debts list	"Baba Ayo paid ₦3,000, balance ₦2,000 on Friday" is recorded and tracked by voice.
Daily summary	Sales, profit and best sellers, read out loud or sent on WhatsApp at the end of the day.
Vendora Business Score	A score built from the trader's own records, used (with permission) to unlock Wema loans.

Wema-powered growth features

Feature	What it does
Open an ALAT account by voice	New traders open a Wema account inside Vendora using BVN or NIN, guided in their language.

Feature	What it does
Smart restock + one-tap loan	"Your rice will finish by Friday. Restock now?" One tap requests a Wema restock loan.
Loans paid to suppliers	Restock loans go straight to verified suppliers, not as cash, which lowers risk for Wema.
Daily repayment from sales	A small amount is set aside from each day's sales, matching how traders actually earn.
Group loans for market associations	Traders in the same association apply together and guarantee each other, like ajo and esusu groups.
Daily savings (digital ajo)	Automatically save a share of daily sales into a Wema savings pot for restocking or emergencies.
Trader becomes a Wema agent	Interested traders offer cash withdrawals and deposits for Wema and earn commission.

Our standout feature: shop assistant mode

Many traders run their stalls with apprentices or shop assistants. In shop assistant mode, each assistant records sales with their own voice and login. **The owner sees exactly who sold what, even when away from the shop.** This tackles a real, painful problem, missing money and stock, that almost no other app solves.

5. How Vendora works with Wema Bank

Vendora is designed as a Wema-native product, not a separate app that happens to use a bank.

Wema connection	Benefit to the trader	Benefit to Wema
ALAT account for every trader	A real bank account opened in minutes	New customers at low cost
Bank-confirmed payments	Protection from fake alerts	More payments flowing through Wema
Pay-per-sale account numbers	Every payment matched to the right sale	Wema becomes the account behind every sale
Vendora Business Score (shared with consent)	Access to fair loans	Clear view of the trader's real business, so safer lending
Loans paid to suppliers	Restock without upfront cash	Money can't be diverted, so lower default risk
Daily repayment and savings	Small, manageable amounts	Better repayment and more deposits
Early warning dashboard	Help before problems grow	Sees falling sales before a missed payment

> **Data and consent.** The trader owns their records. Vendora shares the Business Score and sales history with Wema only when the trader agrees, for example when applying for a loan. Vendora will follow Nigeria's data protection rules and Central Bank of Nigeria guidelines.

6. Technology

- **Speech recognition:** open-source speech models (such as Whisper), fine-tuned on Nigerian market speech in Pidgin, Yoruba, Igbo and Hausa, including mixed-language sentences.
- **Understanding the sentence:** a lightweight language model plus rules that pull out items, quantities, prices, names and debts.
- **Offline-first app:** an Android app (Android 7 and above) that saves everything on the phone first and syncs to the cloud when online.
- **Local languages offline:** English and Pidgin can be understood on the phone. When Vendora is unsure about a Yoruba, Igbo or Hausa sentence offline, it saves the voice note as "pending" and finishes it when network returns.
- **Bank connection:** Wema/ALAT services for account opening, payment notifications, pay-per-sale account numbers and loans (to be confirmed with Wema's technical team).
- **WhatsApp:** connected through Meta's WhatsApp Business Platform.

7. Business model

Free and premium

Essentials stay free, because loans and fraud protection should reach every trader. Growth tools are premium.

Free for every trader	Premium (for growing businesses)
Voice recording of sales and stock	Shop assistant mode (multiple staff)
Wema payment confirmation	Multiple shops under one owner
Customer debts list	Unlimited WhatsApp confirmations
Business Score and Wema loans	Advanced insights and bundle suggestions
Daily summary	Printable business statements, debt reminders sent to customers, market price alerts

Premium is planned at around **₦1,500 to ₦3,000 per month**, to be tested with traders during our pilot.

Three revenue streams

1. **Premium subscriptions** from traders.
2. **Partnership revenue** with Wema: a share of loan and payment revenue from Vendora traders.
3. **WhatsApp channel sponsorship** by Wema as a customer-acquisition channel.

Keeping WhatsApp affordable

Since October 1, 2026, Meta charges businesses for each reply sent on the WhatsApp Business Platform, about $0.0101 per message in Nigeria, plus provider fees. To keep costs low, Vendora groups confirmations (for example, "Recorded 6 sales: ₦31,500"), sends one

daily summary, and keeps detailed checking inside the app, where it costs nothing per message. Our early estimate is about **$1 to $2 per active trader per month**, far cheaper for Wema than reaching the same customers through branches or field agents.

8. Expected impact

Area	Before Vendora	With Vendora
Records	Paper notebooks, lost sales, night-time guessing	Every sale recorded by voice, safely backed up
Fraud	Fake alerts and unconfirmed transfers	Payments confirmed by Wema and matched to each sale
Staff	Missing money, no way to know who sold what	Each assistant's sales tracked separately
Stock	Running out without warning	Early warnings and restock suggestions
Finance	No records, no bank loans	Business Score unlocks Wema restock loans
Savings	Money mixed with daily spending	Automatic daily savings with Wema

9. Pilot and rollout plan

Phase	Timeline	What we will do
1. Market pilot	Months 1 to 3	Test with traders in one market (for example Bodija, Ibadan) through the market association. Improve voice accuracy in real market noise. Track sales recorded, accuracy, and fake alerts stopped.
2. Wema integration	Months 4 to 6	Connect ALAT account opening, payment confirmation and pay-per-sale account numbers. Launch the Business Score and first restock loans with a small group.
3. Growth	Months 7 to 12	Expand to more markets with market associations and cooperatives. Launch group loans, daily savings, premium features and the WhatsApp channel at scale.
4. Beyond Nigeria	Year 2+	Add more languages and take Vendora to other African markets with Wema's partners.

10. Risks and how we will handle them

Risk	Our plan
Noisy markets confuse voice recognition	Train on real market recordings, support Bluetooth earpieces, and always read back each entry so the trader can correct it.
Local languages are harder offline	Save unclear voice notes as "pending" and finish them when network returns.
Traders worry about data privacy	Clear consent before any data is shared. The trader owns their records and can stop sharing at any time.

Risk	Our plan
Loan defaults	Loans paid to suppliers, small daily repayments, group guarantees and early warnings from sales data.
WhatsApp costs grow with users	Grouped replies, app-first design, and Wema sponsorship of the channel.
Low trust in new technology	Peer-led training through market leaders and associations, in local languages.

11. Why Vendora fits Hackaholics 7.0

- It tackles one of the biggest pains of 2026: small traders squeezed by high costs, poor records and fraud.
- It sits squarely in the **Financial Inclusion** focus area, bringing informal traders into formal banking and credit.
- It is built for Wema: new ALAT customers, more deposits and payments, and a safe way to grow small-business lending with its new capital.
- It is designed for ordinary Nigerians, in their own languages, on low-cost phones, even without internet.
- It is led by a woman, building for markets where many traders are women.

12. Conclusion

Market traders do not need more complicated software. They need technology that works the way they already do: by talking. Vendora turns a trader's voice into accurate records, protected payments and, for the first time, a path to bank loans. Built with Wema Bank, Vendora can bring thousands of traders into formal banking, one conversation at a time.